Whitney Kotlewski, PhD

VP of Product Experiences | Strategy & Portfolio Leadership | AI, Data & Spatial Platforms

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SUMMARY

Product executive with 17+ years leading strategy, vision, AI roadmaps, and execution across data and spatial platforms. Directs cross-functional teams, guides organizations through change, and partners with executive leadership to set priorities and deliver business results across enterprise software and mission-critical operations.

SKILLS

Product strategy, Portfolio management, Roadmap prioritization, AI strategy, Customer discovery, Go-to-market, Sales enablement, Opportunity sizing, Developer platforms, APIs and SDKs, MCP, Enterprise capabilities, Organizational leadership, Hiring and budgeting, AI/ML, Data platforms, Design systems

EXPERIENCE

Vice President of Product

Slingshot Aerospace | Windsor, CO | 04/2026 - Present

- Delivered Slingshot Portal's reusable platform in 2 months; grew users 3x in 4 months.
- Own vision and roadmaps for space operations intelligence and autonomy, articulating AI strategy, APIs, MCP, and enterprise capabilities.
- Established a biweekly release cadence, enabling consistent delivery and deeper measurement of adoption, usage, and customer feedback to validate product decisions and inform roadmap priorities.
- Report to the CTO; scaled the product organization ~6x across product management, strategy, design, research, customer experience, and space data in the U.S. and U.K.
- Partner with GTM and leadership on sales, demonstrations, and strategic opportunities during a tenure encompassing ~$124M in company capital raised and $96M+ in U.S. Space Force awards, including $27M for AI training and a $69.2M Phase III contract.
- Built Product Superbase, an AI-enabled knowledge base of 25K+ source files spanning research, sales, market, and usage data, connecting decisions and delivery evidence to team workflows; improved roadmap alignment.

Senior Director of Product

Slingshot Aerospace | Windsor, CO | 2025 - 04/2026

- Led product management, strategy, design, and research for Slingshot's space operations products; promoted to Vice President of Product.

Head of Product Design and Research

Slingshot Aerospace | Windsor, CO | 04/2024 - 2025

- Established shared product and marketing design systems with ~240 tokens and 1,200+ mission-operations components to support reuse across platform experiences; promoted to Senior Director of Product.

Director of Product Design (Platform and Services)

Matterport | 04/2021 - 10/2023

- Led design across eight platform experiences spanning web, marketplace, eCommerce, cloud, enterprise, and developer APIs and SDKs following a ~$2.9B public listing.
- Company revenue grew from ~$111M to ~$158M and subscribers nearly doubled (~1.9x) by FY2023.
- Scaled design 8x and helped expand the broader organization ~3x; led hiring, organizational planning, budgeting, and strategic planning.

- Integrated AI/ML into 3D digital twins; advanced research, accessibility, and design systems; partnered with Marketing on customer journeys, positioning, and launches.

Head of UX Innovation and Special Programs
Esri | 12/2019 - 04/2021

- Led enterprise product and UX innovation across analytics, drone mapping, mobile navigation, 2D/3D mapping, and developer APIs and SDKs, including applied machine learning, as company revenue grew from ~$1.1B to $1.3B+.
- Led a five-person design team.

Design Lead and Senior UX Architect
Esri | 10/2014 - 12/2019

- Led UX design and architecture for Esri analytics and mapping products; promoted to Head of UX Innovation and Special Programs.

Co-Founder and Director
Black Girls MAPP | 02/2019 - 05/2021

- Co-founded a 150+ person civic technology initiative, concurrent with Esri, delivering 24 maps, 24 data layers, 59 apps, and 10 civic products; recognized with the 2021 AAG Diversity and Inclusion Award.

Executive Design Advisor and Advisory Board Member
Sonara | 07/2022 - 10/2023

- Advised the CEO and CIO on experience strategy and operational improvements, helping grow subscription purchases ~80x. Acquired by BOLD in 2024.

Adjunct Professor
Claremont Graduate University | 08/2024 - Present

- Created Design for Good, the university's first-ever novel incubator program and course.

Customer Experience Lead and Research Consultant
Pacific Life | 02/2014 - 10/2014

- Led customer experience and research consulting.

UX Design Lead, Instructor, and Researcher
Indiana University-Purdue University Indianapolis (IUPUI) | 07/2010 - 07/2013

- Led UX design, taught, and conducted research.

Media, Web, and Print Designer
Freelance | 04/2009 - 07/2013

- Designed media, web, and print work for multiple clients.

EDUCATION

Claremont Graduate University
Doctor of Philosophy (PhD), Information Systems and Technology | 2024

- AI and data visualization dissertation; patent pending.

Indiana University-Purdue University Indianapolis (IUPUI)
Master of Science (MS), Informatics | 2013

Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute
Master of Science (MS), Human-Computer Interaction | 2010

Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute
Bachelor of Science (BS), Electronic Media, Arts and Communications | 2010